

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Organization Operating System

A product specification for the organization experience in StartupVerse — the operating layer for programs, mentors, startup portfolios, communication, and outcomes.

DOCUMENT	STATUS	OWNER	LAST UPDATED
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Executive summary

StartupVerse already provides a meaningful foundation for founders, talent, teams, organizations, cohorts, mentors, deliverables, analytics, messaging, notifications, calendar workflows, and in-app calling. The organization experience should now become a coherent operating system: a place where an organization creates a program, enrolls startups, assigns mentors, provides structured work, communicates with participants, and measures progress.

PRODUCT NORTH STAR

Make every organization feel like a capable program operator from day one: clear portfolio visibility, structured founder support, and measurable outcomes in one calm workspace.

This PRD is intentionally opinionated about structure and sequencing. It treats today's organization surfaces as the foundation, then defines the product model needed to make them feel connected, predictable, and useful at scale.

Contents

SECTION	WHAT IT ANSWERS
01 Product context	Why the organization surface matters now
02 Users and jobs	Who uses it and what success looks like
03 Product model	How organizations, programs, startups, mentors, and teams relate
04 Experience architecture	How the organization workspace should be structured
05 Requirements	What must be built, by priority and capability
06 Workflows	The core journeys from creation to outcomes
07 Trust and operations	Permissions, notifications, calls, analytics, and safeguards
08 Delivery plan	Phases, dependencies, metrics, and acceptance criteria
Appendix	Open questions, glossary, and source-of-truth notes

HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

“Current foundation” describes capabilities already represented in the repository. “Target” describes the intended product behavior. “Future” is deliberately sequenced after the core organization operating loop is reliable.

01 Product context

The problem

Organizations are currently modeled as administrators managing cohorts, milestones, deliverables, events, communication, mentors, resources, members, and analytics. The building blocks exist, but the experience does not yet make the operating model obvious. Navigation, program management, participant management, mentor operations, and outcome reporting feel like separate tools instead of one continuous workflow.

The opportunity

Give organizations a clear home base that answers three questions immediately: What programs are running? Which startups need attention? What progress and outcomes can we prove? The answer should be visible without requiring an administrator to understand the internal data model.

Product principles

- Program-first: the program is the organizing unit for startups, mentors, work, communication, and reporting.
- Portfolio clarity: the organization can scan the health of every startup, then drill into one founder and team.
- Structured support: mentors do not merely exist in a directory; they have assignments, context, touchpoints, and workload visibility.
- Participant agency: founders can discover, accept, decline, and act on organization or program invitations.
- Evidence over theater: analytics are grounded in activity, milestones, submissions, deliverables, and outcomes already captured in the product.
- Calm professionalism: use hierarchy, spacing, and strong states instead of decorative visual noise.

Current foundation observed in the product

AREA	CURRENT FOUNDATION	PRD IMPLICATION
Identity	Founder, team-member, talent, mentor, organization-admin roles.	Keep role-based routing and permissions explicit.
Organization	Organization profile, admins, settings, logo, website.	Add operating metadata and member roles over time.
Programs	Cohort creation, dates, status, soft delete, memberships.	Treat “program” as the user-facing term; cohort remains an implementation alias if needed.
Program work	Milestones, structured milestones, tasks, deliverables, resources, events.	Unify them under a program workspace and founder-facing timeline.
Mentors	Organization mentors, expertise, founder assignments, mentor portal.	Add assignment context, capacity, and interaction history.
Visibility	Portfolio, startup snapshots, cohort analytics, program metrics.	Make attention and health the primary dashboard language.

AREA	CURRENT FOUNDATION	PRD IMPLICATION
Communication	Messages, announcements, notifications, meetings, LiveKit call foundation.	Connect notifications, messaging, voice, and video to program context.

02 Users and jobs

USER	PRIMARY JOB	MUST FEEL LIKE
Organization admin	Create and run programs; manage staff, mentors, startups, communication, and outcomes.	A program operator with a reliable command center.
Program manager	Coordinate a specific program, track participation, and keep founders moving.	A clear workspace with the right context, not a database.
Mentor	Understand assigned startups, prepare for sessions, communicate, and record useful follow-up.	A focused support queue with enough context to be effective.
Founder	Evaluate and accept invitations, participate in programs, submit work, meet mentors, and view feedback.	A partner in the program, never a passive record.
Team member	Contribute to program work through the startup team.	Included in the work without losing founder-level clarity.
Platform admin	Safeguard roles, data, and system-wide integrity.	Able to audit without becoming part of normal program work.

User stories

- As an organization admin, I can create a program with dates, description, eligibility, milestones, mentors, and a clear invitation path.
- As a program manager, I can see which startups are active, stalled, overdue, or missing submissions without opening each startup one by one.
- As a mentor, I can see the startups assigned to me, their current goals, recent activity, and next recommended action.
- As a founder, I can receive an invitation, understand the program before joining, accept or decline it, and see the program on my workspace.
- As a founder, I can receive a mentor assignment and know how to contact or schedule time with that mentor.
- As an organization admin, I can communicate with a founder or team by message, announcement, voice call, or video call in the right context.
- As a program manager, I can export or share a trustworthy summary of participation, progress, and outcomes.

Non-goals for the first organization release

- Investor marketplace or investment decisions.
- Paid program billing, subscriptions, or financial settlement.
- Public social feeds or a broad community forum inside the organization workspace.
- Recording calls or automated transcription.
- Advanced AI coaching or predictive startup scoring before the underlying activity data is reliable.

03 Product model

The organization operating loop

ONE LOOP

Create program → invite startups → accept membership → assign mentors → run work and sessions → collect submissions → review progress → communicate → report outcomes → archive or renew.

ENTITY	DEFINITION	KEY RELATIONSHIPS
Organization	The operating entity that owns programs, staff, mentors, resources, and portfolio visibility.	Owns many programs; has admins and mentors.
Program	A time-bounded or ongoing support experience with eligibility, milestones, deliverables, events, and communication.	Belongs to one organization; includes many startups and mentors.
Startup	A founder-led company workspace with a team, goals, tasks, and execution history.	Can join multiple programs; retains one source of startup truth.
Program membership	The startup's participation record in a program.	Has status, invited/joined dates, founder/team visibility, and progress.
Mentor	A person invited or affiliated with an organization to support founders.	Can be assigned to one or more startups/programs with capacity limits.
Assignment	The explicit relationship between mentor, startup, and program.	Creates accountability and access boundaries.
Submission	Founder/team evidence sent to a program for review.	May relate to a milestone or deliverable; receives status and feedback.
Interaction	A message, announcement, meeting, voice call, video call, or note tied to context.	Should retain program/startup/participant context where appropriate.

Recommended naming

Use “program” in the user interface and product language because founders join programs and organizations run programs. Preserve “cohort” as a compatibility term only where existing APIs or database models require it. The user should not have to understand that distinction.

State model

OBJECT	STATES
Program	Draft · Upcoming · Active · Completed · Archived
Invitation	Pending · Accepted · Declined · Expired · Revoked

OBJECT	STATES
Membership	Invited · Active · Paused · Completed · Withdrawn · Removed
Mentor assignment	Proposed · Active · Paused · Ended
Submission	Not started · Draft · Submitted · In review · Changes requested · Accepted
Startup health	On track · Needs attention · At risk · Inactive · Unknown

04 Experience architecture

Organization workspace information architecture

NAVIGATION	PURPOSE	PRIMARY ACTION
Overview	Program and portfolio command center; attention queue; upcoming activity.	Create program / review attention
Programs	List and manage every program with status, dates, member count, and health.	Open / create / archive program
Portfolio	Cross-program view of startups, health, activity, milestones, and submissions.	Filter / inspect startup
Analytics	Program and organization performance, participation, progress, and outcomes.	Filter / compare / export
Mentors	Mentor directory, expertise, capacity, assignments, and activity.	Invite / assign / rebalance
Communication	Announcements, messages, meetings, calls, and follow-up.	Compose / schedule / call
Resources	Program resources, templates, recordings/links, and guidance.	Publish / organize resource
Settings	Organization profile, admins, permissions, notifications, and defaults.	Edit / manage access

Overview page structure

- Header: organization name, type, program switcher, date range, and primary Create program action.
- Attention strip: overdue submissions, at-risk startups, unassigned mentors, pending invites, and upcoming sessions.
- Program summary: active programs with status, dates, startup count, participation, and progress indicators.
- Portfolio snapshot: startup health distribution and a short list of startups needing attention.
- Upcoming: sessions, milestones, events, and deadlines.
- Recent activity: submissions, joins, mentor notes, announcements, and calls.
- Empty states that tell the organization what to do next instead of showing blank cards.

Program workspace structure

Every program should have a consistent shell: program header and status, member count, date range, program navigation, quick actions, and a persistent context label. The program dashboard should prioritize members and attention first; configuration should be available but should not dominate the operating view.

DESIGN DIRECTION

Black/charcoal surfaces, white type, gray borders, and a single neutral emphasis system. Use layout, type weight, and state labels as the primary signals. Avoid gradients, bright decorative fills, and novelty cards.

05 Requirements**Priority scale**

PRIORITY	MEANING
P0	Required for a usable organization operating loop.
P1	High-value capability for the first complete release.
P2	Important expansion after core usage is stable.
P3	Exploratory or scale-stage capability.

A. Organization setup and governance

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
ORG-01	Create an organization with name, description, type, website, logo, and default settings.	P0
ORG-02	Manage organization admins with explicit creator/admin status and safe removal behavior.	P0
ORG-03	Configure organization notification defaults, program defaults, and member visibility rules.	P1
ORG-04	Support multiple programs per organization with independent status and lifecycle.	P0
ORG-05	Provide an audit trail for membership, assignment, permission, and status changes.	P1

B. Program creation and management

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
PROG-01	Create a program with title, description, start/end dates, status, eligibility, capacity, and application/invite mode.	P0

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
PROG-02	Configure milestones, structured tasks, deliverables, checkpoints, categories, owners, and due dates.	P0
PROG-03	Invite one founder, multiple founders, or a startup list to join a program.	P0
PROG-04	Show program preview before a founder accepts an invitation.	P0
PROG-05	Pause, complete, archive, restore, or duplicate a program without losing historical records.	P1
PROG-06	Publish program resources and events in one contextual workspace.	P1

C. Startup invitations and membership

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
MEM-01	Notify founders in-app when invited to an organization or program.	P0
MEM-02	Allow founders to accept, decline, or defer an invitation with a clear reason where useful.	P0
MEM-03	Display accepted and pending programs in the founder workspace.	P0
MEM-04	Include team visibility and participation rules when a founder joins.	P1
MEM-05	Allow organization admins to revoke, pause, remove, or reinstate membership with reason capture.	P1
MEM-06	Prevent duplicate invitations and show invitation status to authorized staff.	P0

05 Requirements (continued)

D. Mentor network and assignments

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
MENT-01	Invite a mentor by registered user or verified email path; show invite state.	P0
MENT-02	Maintain mentor profile with expertise, bio, availability, and organization relationship.	P0
MENT-03	Assign a mentor to a startup within a program, with assignment start/end and scope.	P0
MENT-04	Show mentor workload: active assignments, capacity, upcoming sessions, and last interaction.	P1
MENT-05	Allow mentor and organization to end or pause assignments without deleting history.	P1
MENT-06	Provide mentors with a focused portal for assigned startups, milestones, messages, and notes.	P1

E. Portfolio analytics and startup insight

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
AN-01	Show organization-level and program-level counts for startups, members, activity, tasks, milestones, outcomes, and submissions.	P0
AN-02	Show startup health based on transparent signals: activity recency, overdue work, submission state, and mentor touchpoints.	P0
AN-03	Provide startup snapshot drill-down with founder/team, progress, recent activity, milestones, deliverables, and communication entry points.	P0
AN-04	Support date, program, status, and health filters.	P1
AN-05	Provide trend views for participation, completion, and outcomes.	P1
AN-06	Export a shareable program summary with definitions and reporting date.	P2

F. Communication, meetings, and calls

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
COM-01	Send program announcements to all members or targeted segments.	P0
COM-02	Message founders, teams, mentors, and organization staff with program/startup context.	P0
COM-03	Schedule meetings and show upcoming sessions in program and participant views.	P1
COM-04	Start in-app voice or video calls from a relevant conversation, startup, mentor assignment, or meeting.	P1
COM-05	Show call state, participants, join/leave behavior, and access boundaries; recording/transcription remain deferred.	P1

G. Founder-facing notifications

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY
NOT-01	Deliver actionable notifications for organization invites, program invites, mentor assignments, submissions, announcements, events, and calls.	P0
NOT-02	Deep-link each notification to the correct review or action state.	P0
NOT-03	Support unread state, notification center, and user preferences.	P1
NOT-04	Avoid duplicate notifications across organization, program, and startup contexts.	P1

06 Core workflows

Workflow 1 — Create and launch a program

1. Admin selects Create program from organization overview.
2. Admin enters identity, dates, eligibility, capacity, and participation mode.
3. Admin adds milestones, deliverables, resources, events, and mentors.
4. Admin reviews a program preview and chooses Save draft or Publish.
5. Published program receives a stable status and shareable invite path.
6. Admin invites founders; each invite creates a pending membership and notification.
7. Overview shows launch checklist until the program has its first active startup.

Workflow 2 — Founder receives and joins

8. Founder receives in-app notification with organization, program, dates, purpose, and action buttons.
9. Founder opens the program preview, reviews expectations, and accepts or declines.
10. Accepting creates an active program membership and makes the program visible in the founder workspace.
11. Founder and team see program milestones, deliverables, events, mentor information, and communication entry points.
12. Organization sees the membership transition, and the next recommended action becomes visible.

Workflow 3 — Assign and operate a mentor relationship

13. Organization selects a mentor and startup within a program.
14. System validates access, existing assignments, and optional capacity limits.
15. Organization creates an assignment with scope, start date, and expected touchpoint cadence.
16. Mentor and founder receive notifications with a link to the relationship workspace.
17. Mentor reviews startup context, communicates, schedules or starts a call, and records follow-up.
18. Organization can see whether the relationship is active and when the last meaningful touchpoint occurred.

Workflow 4 — Review startup health

19. Organization opens Portfolio or Analytics.
20. System summarizes transparent signals and labels each startup On track, Needs attention, At risk, Inactive, or Unknown.
21. Admin filters by program, health, activity, milestone state, or submission state.
22. Admin opens a startup snapshot and takes an action: message, invite mentor, request submission, schedule meeting, or start call.
23. Action updates the activity timeline and notification context.

07 Trust and operations

Permissions model

ACTOR	CAN SEE	CAN DO
Organization creator/admin	Organization, all programs, members, mentors, analytics, communications, settings.	Create/manage programs, invite/remove, assign mentors, send communications, manage admins.
Program manager	Assigned programs and their members, work, analytics, and communications.	Operate assigned programs within configured permissions.
Mentor	Assigned startups/programs and explicitly shared context.	Message, meet, review allowed work, and record mentor follow-up.
Founder	Own startup/team plus programs they joined or were invited to.	Accept/decline, submit work, message, meet, and manage participation.
Team member	Startup/team context and program content shared with the startup.	Contribute to work and join permitted communications.

Safety and privacy requirements

- Every organization and program read/write action must enforce server-side authorization; UI hiding is not authorization.
- Founder and team data must be scoped to active organization/program relationships and the minimum necessary visibility.
- Mentor access must be limited to assigned startups/programs unless explicitly expanded by an admin.
- Calls must use the same participant authorization as the underlying conversation or meeting context.
- Membership removal, mentor assignment changes, and program archival must preserve historical reporting integrity.
- Analytics labels must expose definitions or tooltips so organizations do not mistake activity signals for business performance truth.
- Notifications should be idempotent and deep-link to a safe state even if the underlying object changes.

Operational edge cases

CASE	EXPECTED BEHAVIOR
Founder already invited	Show existing status; do not create duplicate pending records.
Founder accepts after program is archived	Block acceptance with clear explanation; keep invitation history.
Mentor removed from organization	End or pause active assignments according to policy and surface unassigned startups.
Startup belongs to multiple programs	Keep one startup source of truth; scope program work and analytics to the selected program.

CASE	EXPECTED BEHAVIOR
Program deleted/archived	Prefer soft delete/archive; retain submissions, outcomes, and audit history.
Call participant loses access mid-call	Prevent rejoin and end access token validity; preserve call event history only.

08 Delivery plan

PHASE	OUTCOME	INCLUDES
Phase 0 — Foundation	A coherent organization shell.	IA cleanup, overview, program switcher, consistent states, terminology, access checks, empty/loading/error states.
Phase 1 — Program loop	Organizations can launch programs and onboard founders.	Create/edit/publish program, invitations, founder notification, accept/decline, membership state, founder program tab.
Phase 2 — Support loop	Organizations can actively support members.	Mentor directory, assignments, mentor workspace, messaging context, announcements, events, submission review.
Phase 3 — Insight loop	Organizations can manage by evidence.	Portfolio health, transparent analytics, attention queue, trend views, exports, activity timeline.
Phase 4 — Live collaboration	Organizations can meet inside StartupVerse.	Contextual voice/video entry points, participant permissions, call states, follow-up activity.
Phase 5 — Scale	Repeatable program operations.	Templates, duplication, capacity planning, advanced reporting, integrations, experiments.

Success metrics

METRIC	DEFINITION	INITIAL SIGNAL
Program activation	Published programs with at least one accepted startup.	Organizations can reach value after setup.
Invitation conversion	Accepted program invitations / delivered program invitations.	The invite preview and notification are understandable.
Time to first support	Time from membership acceptance to first mentor touchpoint or meaningful org interaction.	The support loop starts quickly.
Submission participation	Active startups submitting at least one required item in a program cycle.	Programs create action, not only membership.
Attention resolution	At-risk/needs-attention startups with a recorded follow-up action within a target window.	Analytics lead to intervention.
Weekly organization retention	Organizations returning to manage programs, members, or outcomes weekly.	The workspace becomes operationally useful.
Call completion	Started calls that connect successfully and end normally.	Voice/video is dependable enough for program work.

Release acceptance criteria

- An organization admin can create, publish, and manage a program without leaving the organization workspace.
- A founder can receive, inspect, accept/decline, and find an organization program invitation from the founder experience.
- A mentor can be invited, assigned to a startup in a program, and shown the assignment context.
- The organization can see portfolio-level progress and drill into a startup snapshot.
- Core communications and notifications link to the correct program/startup context.
- Permissions are enforced server-side for organization, program, mentor, founder, and team-member actions.
- Every major surface has designed loading, empty, error, and success states.
- The experience is responsive and remains usable with one organization, many organizations, zero programs, and many programs.

Appendix

Open questions to resolve before engineering lock

- Should a founder be able to discover and apply to public programs, or are all programs invite-only in the first release?
- Can a startup join the same program more than once, or does re-entry create a new membership cycle?
- Should organization roles distinguish owner, admin, program manager, reviewer, and mentor coordinator in v1?
- What is the minimum definition of an “outcome” for reporting: milestone completion, deliverables, weekly outcomes, or an explicit program outcome record?
- Should mentor notes be private to the mentor, shared with the organization, shared with the founder, or configurable per note?
- Which notification channels are required beyond in-app: email, push, or calendar integration?
- What retention and deletion rules apply to organization activity, submissions, messages, and call metadata?

Glossary

TERM	MEANING
Organization	The entity that creates and operates programs.
Program	The user-facing name for a structured organization offering; existing code may call this a cohort.
Startup	The founder-led company workspace participating in StartupVerse.
Founder	The startup owner or lead participant.
Team member	A contributor to the startup team.
Mentor	An organization-affiliated support person assigned to founders/startups.
Membership	A startup’s participation record in a program.
Submission	Evidence or work sent by a founder/team for review.
Touchpoint	A meaningful mentor or organization interaction: message, meeting, call, or recorded follow-up.

Repository source-of-truth notes

This PRD is grounded in the existing StartupVerse implementation and project documentation: organization and cohort models/controllers, organization dashboard and navigation, mentor management and portal surfaces, cohort analytics, deliverables/milestones/resources/events, notifications, messaging, meeting/calendar foundations, and the LiveKit-based call plan. It is a product direction document, not a claim that every listed requirement is already implemented.

DECISION TO MAKE NEXT

Approve the target information architecture and the Phase 0–1 scope before redesigning the organization page. Once the operating loop is agreed, the remaining features can be added without making the page feel like a collection of unrelated modules.